

Gautam Velpula

Head of Enterprise Architecture

Cloud Modernization • GenAI & Agentic AI • Platform Engineering • DevSecOps

gautamvelpula@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/gautamvelpula | 678-539-0154

Executive Summary

Enterprise Architecture leader with 18+ years of experience driving large-scale digital transformation, cloud modernization, and platform engineering across financial services, payments, retail, and consumer technology. Proven track record of building Enterprise Architecture communities, defining target-state architectures, and governing the adoption of emerging technologies including GenAI, Agentic AI, microservices, and event-driven systems. Combines executive strategy, hands-on technical depth, and stakeholder leadership to deliver reusable enterprise capabilities, reduce time-to-market, and balance agility with governance, security, and compliance.

Core Competencies

Enterprise Architecture • Cloud Architecture (AWS, GCP, Azure) • GenAI & Agentic AI • Platform Engineering • DevSecOps • Microservices & Event-Driven Architecture • API Strategy • SAFe Agile & Scrum • Reference Architectures & Reusable Patterns • Application Portfolio Management • Business Cases & TCO • Risk & Compliance • Executive Stakeholder Engagement • Architecture Community Building & Mentorship

Professional Experience

GoTo Foods LLC

2021 – Present

Sr Director, Enterprise Architecture

- Serve as the single Enterprise Architecture authority for a multi-brand enterprise spanning digital, marketing, payments, and data, partnering directly with executive leadership to align technology investments with business strategy and outcomes.
- Established and lead an Enterprise Architecture community of principal and lead architects, sponsoring workshops, fostering cross-domain collaboration, and driving the development of reusable patterns and reference architectures consumed by the broader technology organization.
- Built an enterprise technology roadmap addressing lifecycle management, cost efficiency, and consolidation across the application portfolio, retiring redundant systems and unifying 7 independent brand apps and websites onto a shared digital platform.
- Re-architected backend systems to a cloud-native microservices and event-driven architecture, standardizing APIs, service contracts, and integration patterns to accelerate delivery across the engineering organization.
- Lead the **GoTo Foods AI Working Group**, the enterprise governing body that reviews and approves all AI-based initiatives company-wide, ensuring strategic alignment, technical viability, and adherence to security, compliance, and AI governance standards.
- Lead the design and adoption of **GenAI and Agentic AI** solutions across digital platforms and internal systems, defining architectural patterns, guardrails, and governance for safe, scalable enterprise use.
- Drive enterprise adoption of **LLM-enabled development practices**, embedding AI capabilities into APIs, event-driven services, and internal tooling in partnership with engineering, data, and product teams.

- Partner with security and compliance to establish DevSecOps standards, secure-by-design patterns, and AI governance, balancing agility with risk management and protection of employee and client data.
- Designed and delivered enterprise payments integration with FreedomPay, enabling digital wallets and modern checkout experiences across all brands.
- Architected and delivered a subscription platform to support new business models, including a hands-on stop-gap service that stabilized revenue during legacy system failures.
- Governed Martech and Customer Data Platform integrations, aligning third-party platforms with a centralized customer data model to enable accurate analytics, attribution, and personalization.
- Reduced time-to-market by approximately 40% and improved system uptime by approximately 30% through architectural standardization and platform consolidation.
- Coach and mentor architects, product owners, and business stakeholders to instill architectural thinking and a shared technology vision.

Slalom Consulting

2018 – 2021

Senior Delivery Principal

- Senior delivery and advisory lead for multi-million-dollar digital transformation, cloud modernization, and payments engagements with Fortune 500 clients, including financial services and large-scale eCommerce organizations.
- Conducted a multi-year Enterprise Architecture assessment of a legacy payments platform for one of the largest eCommerce companies in the U.S., defining the target-state architecture, modernization roadmap, and reusable platform capabilities.
- Led a major cloud migration from on-premises and **AWS to GCP** for a leading point-of-sale provider, modernizing infrastructure, data, and application tiers.
- Designed and delivered payment processing systems for a large financial services organization, addressing resilience, high-volume transaction processing, and regulatory requirements.
- Served as primary executive-facing technology advisor, translating business strategy into actionable architecture roadmaps, business cases, and TCO models for technology investments and large transformation efforts.
- Implemented Agile and DevOps operating models across engineering, architecture, product, and design teams, increasing deployment frequency by approximately 30% and reducing lead time by approximately 25%.
- Directed multiple multi-million-dollar engagements, achieving approximately 95% client satisfaction and consistent repeat business.
- Mentored delivery principals and architects, strengthening leadership depth, architectural thinking, and delivery maturity.

Jacada (acquired by Uniphore)

2014 – 2018

Director, Professional Services

- Owned global professional services delivery for enterprise customers, leading large-scale implementations and integrations for Fortune 500 clients with end-to-end accountability across pre-sales, solution architecture, delivery, and post-implementation optimization.
- Served as senior-most technical leader within services, providing architectural guidance, escalation support, and technology evangelism for emerging capabilities.
- Advised C-level stakeholders, aligning delivery with business outcomes, driving organizational change, and managing executive relationships.
- Supported sales through POCs, demos, and solution design, and partnered with product management to influence product roadmap based on enterprise client needs.
- Built and scaled a global professional services organization through recruiting, training, and standardized delivery practices.

Technology & Methodology

Cloud & Platform: AWS, Google Cloud Platform (GCP), Microsoft Azure (AKS, Front Door, API Management, Functions, Blob Storage), Vercel, Cloudflare

Architecture & Integration: Microservices, Event-Driven Architecture, REST / GraphQL APIs, API Gateways, SOA, SaaS / IaaS / PaaS

AI / ML: GenAI, Agentic AI, LLM application patterns, AI governance & guardrails

Languages & Frameworks: TypeScript, Node.js, Java (Spring Boot), NestJS, Next.js, React Native, Tailwind CSS

Data & Messaging: Cosmos DB (MongoDB & PostgreSQL APIs), Databricks, Event Hub, Service Bus

Analytics & Observability: GA4, Firebase, Splunk

Payments, Martech & Integrations: FreedomPay, Amperity CDP, Olo, Punchh, Yext, Qu POS

Methodologies & Frameworks: SAFe Agile, Scrum, DevSecOps, Platform Engineering, Enterprise Architecture Governance, Application Portfolio Management

Education

Master of Science in Information Technology *2007 – 2009*

George Mason University, Fairfax, VA

Bachelor of Technology in Computer Science *2002 – 2006*

Osmania University, Hyderabad, India